

Phishing Email Analysis — Case 001

- **Analyst:** Justin J. Rodriguez
- **Analysis Date:** October 7, 2026
- **Objective:** Determine whether the email is phishing and explain the evidence.
- **Email subject:** “CONGRATULATIONS ... YOU ARE A WEEKLY WINNER.”
- **Sender address:** no-reply@naustipgkqfcdp
- **Reply-To address:** reply-T44FCBZM1IRTIFQB0LGOPUXB@in2.getdrip.com
- **Date received:** October 6, 2026, at 3:29 PM EDT
- **Message analysis:**
 - The sender of this email wants the recipient to click the “Check Eligibility” button to accept/claim their “PS5 Pro + GTA VI Bundle”. Asking for a confirmation of email within the link, the sender wants the recipient to click the “check eligibility” link. The destination has not yet been examined, so phishing or malware cannot be confirmed.
 - The email states “Limited availability. Check now while the offer lasts.” The image shows November 19, 2026, but does not clearly establish an entry deadline. This language creates urgency and encourages quick participation. As well it includes things like “quick signup,” “free,” “opt out anytime.” No direct threats are visible and impersonation remains unconfirmed
- **Header analysis:**
 - The reviewed routing information shows an internal delivery step between Outlook servers. The authentication results record a connecting IP of 20.110.181.37 and a claimed server name of dq8w.Nestora.com. SPF and DMARC returned “none,” and DKIM returned “none” because the message was not signed. These results provide no successful SPF, DKIM, or DMARC authentication evidence in this entry. Combined with the unusual From domain, this increases suspicion but does not independently confirm phishing.
- **Links and attachments:**
 - The “Check Eligibility” button links to [http://vbrightnova\[.\]com/cl/...](http://vbrightnova[.]com/cl/...) The URL uses HTTP and a domain different from the sender and Reply-To domains, with no obvious connection to the advertised PS5 promotion. The final destination and page contents were not examined, so credential collection or malware cannot be confirmed. No attachments were visible in Apple Mail. The URL was copied without opening it.
- **Verdict and confidence:**
 - Verdict: Inconclusive; suspicious promotional email. Confidence is moderate that the message is suspicious. Phishing remains unconfirmed because the final destination was not examined.

- **Recommended response:**
 - The recipient should avoid clicking links, replying, or providing personal information. After preserving evidence for the investigation, they should report the email as suspicious through their mail provider and delete it to prevent accidental interaction.

Evidence:

Figure 1: Email Message

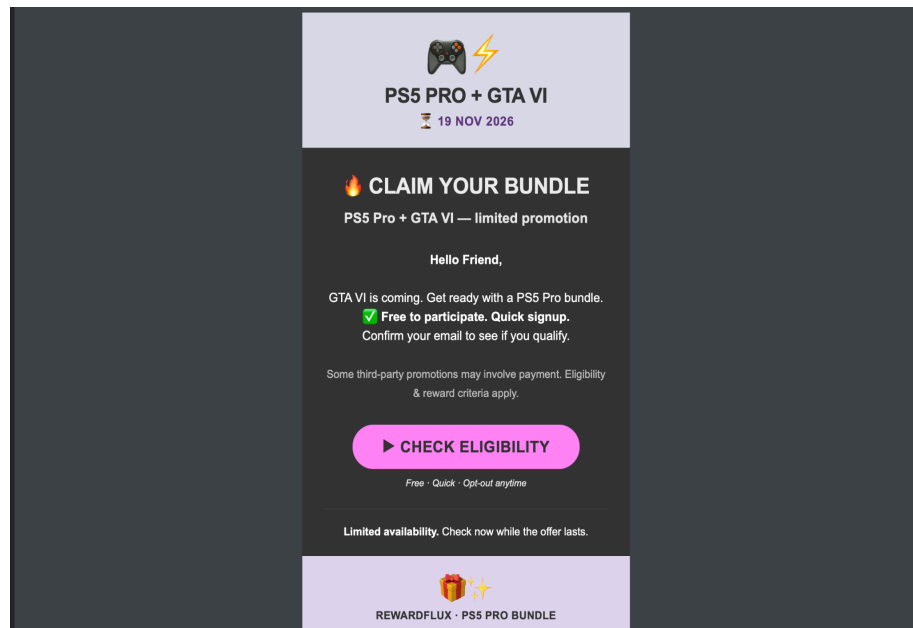


Figure 2: Sender Address

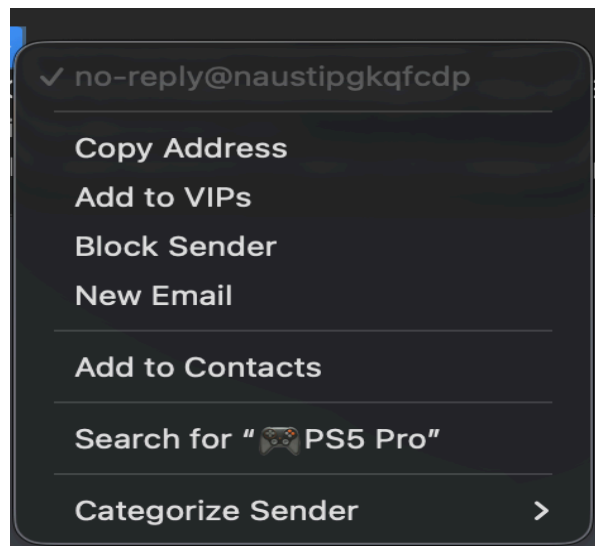


Figure 3: Email Authentication Results

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Received: from DM3NAM02FT021.mail.protection.outlook.com  
(2603:10b6:5:3ad:cafe::7a) by DS7PR03CA0298.outlook.office365.com  
(2603:10b6:5:3ad::33) with Microsoft SMTP Server (version=TLS1_2,  
cipher=TLS_ECDHE_RSA_WITH_AES_256_GCM_SHA384) id 15.21.472.20 via Frontend  
Transport; Tue, 6 Oct 2026 19:29:03 +0000  
Authentication-Results: mx.microsoft.com 1; spf=none (sender IP is  
20.110.181.37) smtp.helo=dq8w.Nestora.com; dkim=none (message not signed)  
header.d=none;dmarc=none action=none header.from=naustipgkqfcdp;  
Received-SPF: None (protection.outlook.com: dq8w.Nestora.com does not  
designate permitted sender hosts)  
Received: from dq8w.Nestora.com (20.110.181.37) by  
DM3NAM02FT021.mail.protection.outlook.com (10.13.4.249) with Microsoft SMTP
```